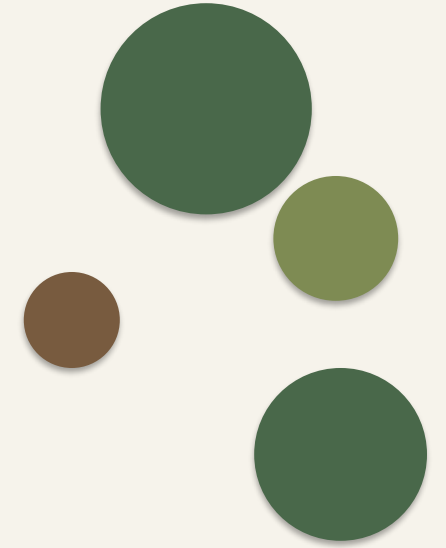


THE SILENT GARDEN

Hackathon 4 -Picture the Planet

AI for Good • SDG 13: Climate Action



1. The problem

What our desk research showed

Pollinators matter

Bees, butterflies, hoverflies and moths help flowering plants reproduce, and pollination supports food production.

A real decline

Our research reports that 1 in 3 bee, butterfly and hoverfly species in Europe is in decline, and 1 in 10 bee and butterfly species is threatened with extinction.

Why climate matters

Climate change and extreme weather can affect floral resources, flowering times and plant-pollinator relationships.

Our problem statement

The decline of pollinators can disrupt the relationships between plants, insects and other organisms that keep ecosystems functioning.

2. SDG 13 & our opportunity

SDG 13 - Climate Action

SDG 13 focuses on urgent action on climate change and its impacts.

Our project connects because climate change is one pressure affecting pollinators and ecosystems.

Existing solutions

Habitat restoration
Reducing pesticides
Pollinator monitoring
EU conservation programmes
Climate adaptation

Our opportunity

We are not trying to create another solution for saving bees.

We asked:

“How can we make this complex problem understandable and emotionally meaningful in just 30 seconds?”

3. Who is this for?

A specific audience instead of “everyone”

Primary user

A young adult aged 18 -30, especially a university student who uses social media and knows about climate change but may have limited awareness of its impact on pollinators and ecosystems.

Secondary users

Teachers, environmental organisations and general audiences who could share the film for climate-awareness or educational purposes.

Not our main audience

Climate scientists, ecologists and policymakers already have specialist knowledge and are not the main audience for a short awareness film.

4. Our concept — The Silent Garden

START

Flowers + bees + butterflies
The garden feels alive.

CHANGE

Heat increases
Flowers wilt and pollinators disappear.

END

One flower remains
The garden becomes silent.

“When nature becomes silent... we should listen.”

5. Story sequence

Eight visual stages

01 — Healthy garden

Flowers, bees and butterfly

02 — Heat arrives

Warm light, dry grass

03 — More stress

Wilting flowers, fewer insects

04 — One stressed flower

Close-up, no insects

05 — Depleted garden

Almost no pollinators

06 — Silence

Dry garden, no wildlife

07 — One survivor

Single white flower

08 — Final image

Flower + space for message

6. How we built it

The complete workflow stayed inside ComfyUI

1

Generate stills

Z-Image → 8
garden images

2

Add motion

Wan 2.2 I2V →
animate each shot

3

Create narration

ChatterBox Official
23-Lang → voice

4

Time audio

TTS/SRT timing +
silence padding

5

Assemble

Concatenate
video clips +
audio

Final film length

About 33.6 seconds

7. Narration & sound

The audio follows the visual story

Narration

“At first, everything was alive.”

“Flowers were blooming everywhere, and bees and butterflies filled the garden with life.”

“Then... the heat came.”

“Slowly, the flowers began to disappear.”

“And the bees stopped coming.”

Ending

“The garden became quiet... and then, silent.”

“When nature becomes silent... we should listen.”

Voice generated with ChatterBox Official 23-Lang inside ComfyUI.

TTS/SRT timing and silence padding were used to fit the narration.

8. Ethical choices

What we tried to be careful about

Fictional story

The garden is fictional, so we are not presenting an AI-generated event or location as real.

No overclaiming

Climate change is shown as one pressure on pollinators, not the only explanation for their decline.

AI transparency

The visuals and narration were generated with AI tools inside ComfyUI.

Energy use

AI generation has a computational and energy cost, so we considered whether the generations were justified by the educational purpose.

9. Final message & reflection

WHEN NATURE BECOMES SILENT, WE SHOULD LISTEN.

What I learned

Building the project was more than generating images. We had to keep the story and visual style consistent across all shots.

What was difficult

Getting the motion, narration and timing to work together took several attempts.

AI for Good

AI helped us communicate an environmental issue in a short format while making us think about accuracy, transparency and energy use.